Circle of support

People who can help

A circle of support is a group of people who can help. These are role types, not names. Use adults you know and trust.

Place	Role types	Help they could give
At home	Parent or carer	Help get kit ready.
At school	Teacher, Teaching assistant	Show a new class step.
In the community	Club leader	Show a new club step.

These are examples. The same help can come from more than one person. A role does not mean you must trust that person.

Safe help

Use the home or school help route you know. Do not go alone to ask a new adult you do not know. If one adult is busy, ask another trusted adult for help.

Story starter

Words: pupil, new, step, help

Start: The pupil could ask ... .

Model: The pupil could ask a teacher.

Use the made-up story in class. For real help, ask a trusted adult in private. You can pass, point or ask for help.

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Role and help sort cards

Match each role card to a kind of help. Use the made-up examples. More than one safe match may fit. Say, point or use your usual aid. Sort on the table or note the match in your book.

Role cards
Parent or carer
Teacher
Teaching assistant
Club leader

Help cards
Help get kit ready at home.
Show the new class steps.
Try the first class step with the pupil.
Show the steps for a new club task.

More than one safe match can fit. These cards do not say all that a person can do.

Guided sort

Words: home, school, club, help

Start: This role could ... .

Model: A parent or carer could help get kit ready.

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A new start to class

This story is made up. No one has to tell a real story.

A pupil has a new start to class. First they put their book on the table. Then they look at the first task. They are not sure what comes next.

Who could help

Teaching assistant

How they could help

Show the next class step.

The pupil could ask a teaching assistant to show the next step.

Your story choice

Choose a helper role. Show how they could help the pupil. Point, say, draw or use your usual aid. Your words and model can stay in view. A scribe can write the words you pick.

More than one safe choice

A teacher could show the steps too. If the first adult is busy, ask another trusted adult.

You can watch, pass, pause or come back with help.

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My circle

Fill this card in private. Use roles, not names. You can write, draw or point. Keep this card.

Do not show this card to the group. An adult can help if you want.

Use role types. Do not write names or real worries here.

At home

Role type: _____

Help they could give: _____

At school

Role type: _____

Help they could give: _____

In the community

Role type: _____

Help they could give: _____

Help in private

You may leave any space blank. Not sure who could help? Ask for help in private. You do not need a role in each space.

Any space can stay blank. You can leave the whole card blank or pass. This card stays with you.

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Aids for the story tasks

Keep words, start and model in view. Your usual aids stay.

Story starter

Words: pupil, new, step, help

Start: The pupil could ask ... .

Model: The pupil could ask a teacher.

Model check

Words: adult, role, show, step

Start: They could help by ... .

Model: A teaching assistant could show the next step.

Guided sort

Words: home, school, club, help

Start: This role could ... .

Model: A parent or carer could help get kit ready.

Private hinge

Words: role, help, next, adult

Start: The pupil could choose ... .

Model: The pupil could choose a teacher to show the steps.

You can point, say, use an aid or pass. Use the made-up story in class.

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Aids for your story choice

Choose and plan

Words: teacher, helper, show, try

Start: They could ask ... to ... .

Model: They could ask a teaching assistant to show the next step.

Story choice and private card

Words: role, help, blank, private

Start: In the story, ... could help by ... .

Model: In the story, a teacher could help by showing the steps.

Feedback and exit

Words: busy, next, help, adult

Start: Another helper could be ... .

Model: Another helper could be a teaching assistant.

Your next step

Keep your first try. Use one next step. Reply in the same colour, on the same page or usual mode.

Help in private

For real help, ask a trusted adult in private. Use your known home or school route. If one adult is busy, ask another trusted adult. You can pause, pass and come back with help.

No names or real worries in class work. My circle stays with you.

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